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Sugar Cookie Recipe

Recipe

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Sugar Cookies are a classic in my kitchen, especially when the holidays roll around. I love how these cookies balance tender centers with crisp edges while still staying firm enough for detailed decorating. They also make baking feel wonderfully creative, whether you're making simple shapes or turning a batch into a special family project.

For more easy homemade desserts and comforting baking ideas, visit NohalieRecipes.com. I hope these Sugar Cookies find their way onto your holiday table, cookie platter, or next special-occasion dessert spread.

These Sugar Cookies rely on a short list of familiar baking staples. Each ingredient has a clear job, so accurate measuring helps you get the tender texture and crisp edges this recipe promises.

 Ingredients

Ingredients

All-purpose flour - 4 cups (480g)

Flour gives the cookie dough its structure and helps the cut-out cookies hold their shapes during baking.

Salt - $\frac{3}{4}$ teaspoon

Salt balances the sweetness and brings out the buttery flavor.

Baking powder - $\frac{3}{4}$ teaspoon

Baking powder gives the cookies a little lift while keeping their shape suitable for decorating.

Unsalted butter - 1 cup (227g), softened

Softened butter blends smoothly with the sugar and gives the cookies their rich, tender texture.

Granulated sugar - 1 cup (200g)

Sugar adds sweetness and contributes to the cookies' crisp edges.

Large eggs - 2

Eggs help bind the dough while adding moisture and structure.

Vanilla extract - 2 teaspoons

Vanilla adds a warm, familiar flavor that makes these simple cookies taste especially inviting.

Complete Ingredients

4 cups all-purpose flour (480g)

¾ teaspoon salt

¾ teaspoon baking powder

1 cup unsalted butter, softened (227g)

1 cup granulated sugar (200g)

2 large eggs

2 teaspoons vanilla extract

Seasoning Options

For the original recipe, keep the ingredient list exactly as written. The vanilla provides the main flavor beyond the buttery sweetness, while the salt keeps the finished cookies from tasting flat.

Pro Tips

1. Soften the butter properly. Softened butter blends more easily with the sugar and helps create the light, fluffy mixture the recipe calls for.
2. Sift the dry ingredients. Sifting the flour, salt, and baking powder together helps distribute the dry ingredients evenly throughout the dough.
3. Cream the butter and sugar well. Beat them on medium speed for about 2 minutes, until the mixture looks light and fluffy.
4. Add the eggs one at a time. Give each egg time to blend into the mixture before adding the next one.
5. Don't skip the chill. Refrigerating the dough for 2 hours makes it easier to roll and cut into clean shapes.
6. Plan ahead for longer chilling. If you refrigerate the dough for more than 2 hours, let it sit at room temperature for 15 to 30 minutes.
7. Roll evenly. Aim for 1/4-inch thickness so the cookies bake at a similar rate and keep a consistent shape.
8. Give the cookies room. Place the cut-outs 1 inch apart on nonstick or parchment-lined baking sheets.
9. Watch the edges. Bake until the bottom edges start to turn brown. That visual cue matters more than relying on color across the entire cookie.
10. Cool before decorating. Let the cookies cool completely before adding royal icing, buttercream, chocolate, or powdered sugar.

1. Sift the dry ingredients

Start by preparing the flour mixture. In a medium bowl, sift together 4 cups (480g) all-purpose flour, $\frac{3}{4}$ teaspoon salt, and $\frac{3}{4}$ teaspoon baking powder. Sifting distributes the dry ingredients and breaks up any lumps.

2. Beat the butter and sugar

Add 1 cup (227g) softened unsalted butter and 1 cup (200g) granulated sugar to a large mixing bowl. Beat on medium speed for about 2 minutes, until the mixture looks light and fluffy.



3. Add the eggs

Add 2 large eggs, one at a time, while mixing. Allow each egg to blend into the butter mixture before adding the next one. Scrape down the sides of the bowl.

4. Add the vanilla

Beat in 2 teaspoons vanilla extract. The vanilla gives these Sugar Cookies their familiar bakery-style flavor and works especially well with the buttery dough.



5. Add the flour mixture

With the mixer running, gradually add the sifted flour mixture. Mix until everything is well incorporated. Once the dough forms, divide it in half.

6. Shape and chill the dough

Shape each half into a disk. Tightly wrap both dough disks in plastic wrap, then refrigerate them for 2 hours. You can also refrigerate the dough for up to 2 days.



7. Preheat the oven

When the dough has chilled and you're ready to bake, preheat the oven to 375°F. While the oven heats, prepare your baking sheets with parchment paper.

8. Roll and cut the dough

Work with the chilled dough on a lightly floured surface. Roll it to 1/4-inch thickness. Use 2½-inch cookie cutters to cut out your shapes.



9. Arrange the cut-outs

Transfer the cut-outs to non-stick or parchment-lined baking sheets. Leave about 1 inch between each cookie. Arrange the cookies in a single layer.

10. Bake the cookies

Bake one sheet at a time for 10 to 12 minutes, or until the bottom edges start to turn brown. Keep an eye on the edges toward the end of the baking time.

11. Cool completely

Let the baked cookies cool for a few minutes on the pan. Then transfer them to a wire rack and let them cool completely before decorating.



Serving Suggestions

Serve these Sugar Cookies plain for a simple buttery treat, or decorate them with royal icing when you're making cookies for holidays and special occasions. Their firm shape makes them a good choice for detailed designs.

Storage & Make-Ahead

You can refrigerate the prepared dough for up to 2 days. If the dough stays chilled longer than the initial 2-hour chilling period, let it sit at room temperature for 15 to 30 minutes, or until slightly softened, before rolling.

Frequently Asked Questions

How long should Sugar Cookies chill before baking?

Chill the dough for 2 hours before rolling and cutting. You can also refrigerate it for up to 2 days. If you chill it longer than 2 hours, let it sit at room temperature for 15 to 30 minutes.

How thick should I roll Sugar Cookies?

Roll the dough to 1/4-inch thickness. Keeping the dough at an even thickness helps the cut-out cookies bake consistently and maintain their shapes.

How long do Sugar Cookies bake?

Bake the cookies one sheet at a time for 10 to 12 minutes at 375°F, or until the bottom edges start to turn brown.

Recipe Card

Ingredients

4 cups all-purpose flour (480g)
¾ teaspoon salt
¾ teaspoon baking powder
1 cup unsalted butter, softened (227g)
1 cup granulated sugar (200g)
2 large eggs
2 teaspoons vanilla extract

Instructions

In a medium bowl, sift together the flour, salt, and baking powder.

Beat the butter and sugar together on medium speed until light and fluffy, about 2 minutes.

Add the eggs, one at a time, while mixing. Scrape down the sides of the bowl. Beat in the vanilla.

Gradually add the flour mixture and mix until well incorporated. Divide the dough in half, shape into two disks, and wrap in plastic. Refrigerate for 2 hours.

Preheat the oven to 375°F. Roll the dough to 1/4-inch thickness and cut out shapes.

Place the cut-outs on baking sheets 1 inch apart.

Bake one sheet at a time for 10 to 12 minutes or until the bottom edges start to turn brown.

Let cool for a few minutes on the pan, then transfer to a wire rack and cool completely.

Cool cookies before decorating. Any icing decorations can melt and run off the cookies if added before they are cooled.